

INSTRUCTIONS FOR FILING
ESTIMATED TAX VOUCHERS

2026

WHAT'S NEW FOR 2026—The standard deduction will increase to **\$3,360.00** for 2026. Individuals, estates, or trusts who electronically file their return will now have the option to have their estimated tax payment(s) debited from their bank account.

WHO MUST MAKE PAYMENTS—Individuals, estates, or trusts who can reasonably expect to have income of more than \$5,000 from which no Kentucky income tax will be withheld may be required to make estimated tax payments as required by KRS 141.305. Payments may be made through withholding, a credit forward from the previous year's income tax return or estimated tax payments. The worksheet on the reverse should be used to determine the amount which should be paid through estimated tax payments. **If the amount of estimated tax for the year is \$500 or less, no payment is required.**

General Rule

In most cases, you must pay estimated tax for 2026 if both of the following apply.

- 1 You expect to owe at least \$500 in tax for 2026, after subtracting your withholding and refundable credits.
- 2 You expect your withholding and refundable credits to be less than the smaller of:
 - (a) 90% of the tax to be shown on your 2026 tax return; or
 - (b) 100% of the tax shown on your 2025 tax return. Your 2025 tax return must cover all 12 months.

Note: These percentages may be different if you are a farmer, fisherman, or higher income taxpayer. See *Special Rules*.

EXCEPTION—You don't have to pay estimated tax payments for 2026 if you had no Kentucky tax liability for the full 12-month 2025 tax year. You had no liability for 2025 if your total tax was zero or you didn't have to file a Kentucky tax return.

SPECIAL RULES

There are special rules for farmers, fisherman, and certain higher income taxpayers.

FARMERS AND FISHERMAN—If at least two-thirds of your gross income for 2025 or 2026 is from farming, substitute 66 ²/₃% for 90% in (2a) under *General Rule*.

HIGHER INCOME TAXPAYERS—If your Kentucky adjusted gross income for 2025 was more than \$150,000 (\$75,000 if your filing status for 2026 is married filing separately), substitute 110% for 100% in (2b) under *General Rule*. This rule does not apply to farmers.

FAMILY SIZE TAX CREDIT—The Family Size Tax Credit is based on modified gross income (MGI) and the size of the family. If your total MGI is \$42,760 or less you may qualify for Kentucky Family Size Tax Credit.

Note: This credit is not applicable to fiduciary returns.

"Modified gross income" used to calculate the Family Size Tax Credit means the greater of:

Federal adjusted gross income adjusted to include interest income derived from municipal bonds (non-Kentucky) and lump-sum pension distributions not included in federal adjusted gross income;

or

Kentucky adjusted gross income adjusted to include lump-sum pension distributions not included in federal adjusted gross income.

PASS-THROUGH ENTITIES AND INDIVIDUAL OWNERS OF DISREGARDED SINGLE MEMBER LLCs—All pass-through entities and individual owners of disregarded single member LLCs that file on Schedules C, E or F for federal income tax purposes are treated the same for Kentucky income tax purposes as they are treated for federal income tax purposes except for the differences between Kentucky law and federal law. Individuals with income from pass-through entities or disregarded single member LLCs that file Schedule C, E or F for federal income tax purposes may be required to make individual estimated tax payments.

WHEN TO PAY—Taxpayers may pay the full amount of estimated tax in one payment on the earliest applicable due date, or they may pay in installments. Installments for calendar year 2026 are due April 15, June 15, September 15, 2026, and January 15, 2027. Any credit from a 2025 income tax return should be applied to the amount owed before any payments are made. Installment payments should not be made until the amount of the credit has been used. A voucher should be filed only when a payment is required.

FARMERS AND FISHERMAN—If at least two-thirds of your gross income for 2025 or 2026 is from farming or fishing, you can do one of the following:

- Pay all of your estimated tax by January 15, 2027.
- File your 2026 Form 740 or Form 740-NP by March 1, 2027, and pay the total tax due. In this case, 2026 estimated tax payments aren't required to avoid a penalty.

ANNUALIZED INCOME INSTALLMENTS—If you receive your income unevenly throughout the year (for example, because you operate your business on a seasonal basis or you have a large capital gain late in the year), you may be able to lower or eliminate the amount of your required estimated tax payment for one or more periods by using the annualized income installments method. See chapter 2 of federal publication 505 for details.

Period When Estimate Required or Change Occurs	Due Date	Number of Equal Installments
January 1–April 1	April 15, 2026	4
April 2–June 1	June 15, 2026	3
June 2–September 1	September 15, 2026	2
September 2–December 31*	January 15, 2027	1

**If the change occurs after September 1, 2026, the voucher is not required if the 2026 Kentucky income tax return is filed and the tax shown to be due is paid on or before February 1, 2027.*

Failure to make required estimated installments by the specified dates may result in penalty due.

FISCAL YEAR FILERS—If you pay tax for a fiscal year instead of a calendar year, your due date is the 15th day of the fourth, sixth and ninth months of your fiscal year and the 15th day of the first month of the following fiscal year.

PENALTY FOR UNTIMELY ESTIMATED PAYMENT—Failure to pay estimated tax installments on or before the due date will result in assessment of penalty on the late payment. This penalty will be calculated using the rate provided by KRS 131.183.

HOW TO USE ESTIMATED TAX VOUCHERS—Enter your name, address and Social Security number(s)/FEIN in the spaces provided. In the payment block, enter the amount of payment. Do not enter amounts paid through a credit from a previous year.

HOW TO PAY—You may pay your estimated tax installments using the following options:

- Pay by check using Form 740-ES. Make check payable to Kentucky State Treasurer, and write your Social Security Number on the face of the check. If you chose to pay your first installment with Form 740, please prepare a separate check for the amount shown on the Form 740-ES voucher and include the voucher marked "Installment 1".
- Form 8879-K, you may authorize the Kentucky Department of Revenue to debit all four of your installments on the dates due. This option must be initiated at the time of the filing and is only available for electronic filers.
- Pay by ACH debit, you may access the Department of Revenue's secure website revenue.ky.gov.

Estimated Tax Worksheet (2026)

1	Enter your total estimated wages subject to withholding.....	1		
2	Enter your total estimated taxable income from sources with no withholding.....	2		
3	Add lines 1 and 2.....	3		
4	Enter estimated adjustments to income.....	4		
5	Subtract line 4 from line 3. This is your ESTIMATED ADJUSTED GROSS INCOME.....	5		
6	Enter estimated allowable itemized deductions or the standard deduction of \$3,360.00 (Enter zero for estates or trusts).....	6		
7	Subtract line 6 from line 5. Enter the difference here. This is your ESTIMATED NET INCOME.....	7		
8	Compute tax on estimated net income from line 7. Multiply line 7 by 3.5% and ENTER TAX HERE..... ➤	8		
9	Enter your tax credits (\$40 if you are 65 or over or blind; \$20 if you are in the Kentucky National Guard).....	9		
10	Enter Family Size Tax Credit using percentage from worksheet below (Enter zero for estates or trusts).....	10		
11	Enter Kentucky income tax to be withheld in 2026. Add lines 9 through 11 and enter total at right.....	11		
12	Subtract the total on line 11 from line 8. This is your Estimated Kentucky Income Tax for 2026. Enter here. If this amount is \$500 or less, estimated tax payment is not required	12		
13(a)	Multiply line 12 by 90% (66 2/3% for farmers and fishermen, see instructions).....	13a		
(b)	Enter amount of tax liability from 2025 return (see 2(b) of General Rule) (Multiply by 110% for high income taxpayers, see instructions).....	13b		
(c)	Required annual payment. Enter the smaller of line 13(a) or 13(b).....	13c		
14	Divide line 13(c) by 4. This is amount of each installment. Enter here and in Column B, lines 1 through 4 of Record of Estimated Tax Payments Schedule.....	14		

Family Size Tax Credit (FSTC) is based on modified gross income (MGI) and the size of the family. Refer to page 1 for the definition of MGI. The 2025 table is provided for your convenience.

Note: This credit is not applicable to fiduciary returns.

Family Size	One		Two		Three		Four or More		Credit Percentage is
If MGI . . .	is over	is not over	is over	is not over	is over	is not over	is over	is not over	
Tax Year 2025	\$ ---	\$ 15,650	\$ ---	\$21,150	\$ ---	\$26,650	\$ ---	\$32,150	100
	15,650	16,276	21,150	21,996	26,650	27,716	32,150	33,436	90
	16,276	16,902	21,996	22,842	27,716	28,782	33,436	34,722	80
	16,902	17,528	22,842	23,688	28,782	29,848	34,722	36,008	70
	17,528	18,154	23,688	24,534	29,848	30,914	36,008	37,294	60
	18,154	18,780	24,534	25,380	30,914	31,980	37,294	38,580	50
	18,780	19,406	25,380	26,226	31,980	33,046	38,580	39,866	40
	19,406	19,876	26,226	26,861	33,046	33,846	39,866	40,831	30
	19,876	20,345	26,861	27,495	33,846	34,645	40,831	41,795	20
	20,345	20,815	27,495	28,130	34,645	35,445	41,795	42,760	10
	20,815	---	28,130	---	35,445	---	42,760	---	0

These two schedules are for your records only and are **not** to be mailed to the Department of Revenue.

AMENDED COMPUTATION SCHEDULE	
<i>Use if your estimated tax substantially changes after you make your first payment.</i>	
1 Enter amended estimated tax	
2 Less:	
(a) Amount of 2025 overpayment credited to 2026 estimated tax.....	
(b) Payments made on 2026 estimated tax to date	
(c) Total of Lines 2(a) and 2(b).....	
3 Unpaid balance (line 1 less line 2(c)).....	
4 Amount to be paid (line 3 divided by number of remaining installments less any unused 2025 overpayment credit). Enter here and in block on voucher.....	

RECORD OF ESTIMATED TAX PAYMENTS SCHEDULE				
	Col. A	Col. B	Col. C	Col. D
Voucher Number	Date	Amount from line 14 above.	2025 overpayment credit applied to installment. Subtract C from B.	Amount to be paid with voucher. Enter here and on Vouchers 1-4.*
1				
2				
3				
4				
Total				

**If zero or less, do not file a voucher. If amount credited exceeds amount of installment enter excess in Column C of the next line.*